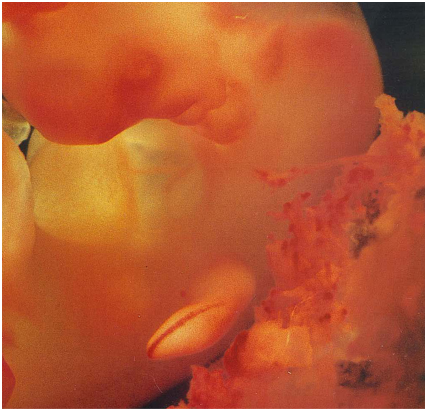




YOU ARE **7 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

227 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The upper and lower limb buds that will form the legs and arms are clearly visible by now. The baby's head is still curled over the chest, but the beginnings of the ears can just be detected as raised areas at the base of the head.

“Your baby's facial features are beginning to develop and over the next few weeks will become much more defined.”

Your baby has ears! Low down, near the jaw line, the ears form, each arising from six small mounds, fusing together to give your baby his unique and individual ear shape. As the face and jaw forms and your baby's neck extends moving away from the chest wall, the ears migrate upward; they will come to lie at the same level as his eyes by 11 weeks.

The baby's lips and nose are now beginning to take shape. To form the upper lip, two separate ridges of tissue grow from each side of your baby's face to fuse with the small piece of tissue in the midline extending downward beneath the nose (the grooved part of the upper lip).

At around this stage, your baby's small and large bowel lengthen. Because they have insufficient room to expand inside the still very curled-up embryo, the intestines appear as a bulge on the surface of the abdominal wall. This bulge is covered by a membrane, into which the umbilical cord becomes attached. The bowel will continue to grow in this embryonic sac until 11–12 weeks when it will be reabsorbed into the abdominal cavity, leaving just the surface attachment of the cord.

ALLERGIES

The risk of a baby developing allergies is not reduced by avoiding common allergens. In a recent study, pregnant and breastfeeding women avoided allergens such as peanuts and delayed introducing certain foods into their babies' diet. It did not decrease allergic disease in babies and toddlers.

CAREFUL COOKING

Your immune system is under extra pressure during pregnancy, making you more susceptible to food poisoning, and some food-borne illnesses can cross the placenta and affect your unborn baby. Always be careful to do the following:

- Wash your hands carefully and regularly, with hot water and soap. Dry them completely before preparing food, since bacteria spread more easily on damp skin. Also thoroughly wash